

# LaunchVector (CareerAI)

## Complete Investor-Ready Startup Blueprint

World-Class Startup Strategy • Venture-Scale Business Plan • Full Pitch Deck • Financial Projections

Confidential — May 2026

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## PART 1: EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

### The Startup Idea

LaunchVector is an **AI-native career intelligence platform** that replaces \$5,000–\$15,000 human reverse recruiters with a \$149/month autonomous AI agent. The platform applies to jobs, crafts hyper-personalized outreach to hiring managers, runs real-time interview coaching, and continuously learns from every outcome — getting measurably smarter with each candidate it serves.

### The Problem Being Solved

Job searching in 2026 is broken in a specific, expensive, and painful way:

| Pain Layer      | What It Costs Candidates                                                               |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Time cost       | 15–25 hours/week on form-filling, job board searching, and copy-paste resume tailoring |
| Financial cost  | \$3,000–\$15,000 for human reverse recruiters — unaffordable for most                  |
| Quality cost    | Human services are inconsistent; personalization is a myth at most price points        |
| Emotional cost  | Black-box processes, no feedback, no visibility into why applications fail             |
| Structural cost | No learning loop — each recruiter starts fresh regardless of past outcomes             |

The \$40K–\$150K salary segment — the largest cohort of active job seekers — is **completely unserved** by premium services and underserved by cheap automation tools.

### The Target Market

**Primary (B2C):** Mid-career professionals earning \$75K–\$150K in tech, finance, and consulting. Actively job searching. Frustrated by DIY. Can't justify \$5K+ for human services.

**Secondary (B2B):** Companies with 500+ employees offering LaunchVector as an outplacement benefit to laid-off workers.

**Tertiary (B2B2C):** Career coaches using LaunchVector as a white-label platform to serve their clients at scale.

The Business Opportunity

| Market Layer                   | Size               | LaunchVector Addressability        |
|--------------------------------|--------------------|------------------------------------|
| US active job seekers annually | ~50M people        | 2.5-5M addressable (5-10%)         |
| Willing to pay \$50-\$350/mo   | ~15-20% of seekers | 375K-1M potential subscribers      |
| Enterprise outplacement market | \$3B+ annually     | \$300M+ serviceable                |
| Career coaching market         | \$15B globally     | \$500M+ via white-label API        |
| Combined SAM (Year 3)          | \$1.5B+            | \$75-150M ARR at 5-10% penetration |

Why Now

Five structural forces make 2026 the optimal entry point:

1. **AI flooding pipelines:** 250+ applicants per role — signal-to-noise is catastrophic. Personalization is no longer optional; it's survival.
  2. **Layoff supercycle:** Ongoing tech and finance layoffs are creating simultaneous mass demand from highly educated, AI-familiar job seekers.
  3. **AI agent maturity:** Browser automation, LLM fine-tuning, and voice AI are now reliable enough to replace 80-85% of human recruiter labor.
  4. **No scaled software player:** The largest reverse recruiting firms have never crossed \$50M ARR because the human-dependent model caps growth. The category is wide open for a software-first entrant.
  5. **Pricing arbitrage moment:** The gap between what human services charge (\$2K-\$15K/month) and what AI can deliver (\$49-\$349/month) creates an unassailable ROI argument that is compelling today and won't exist once the market catches up.
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# PART 2: COMPLETE BUSINESS PLAN

## 2.1 Problem Statement

The modern job search is an asymmetric information war. Employers use sophisticated ATS systems, AI screening tools, and structured interview processes. Job seekers respond with manually tailored resumes, cold applications into black-box systems, and hope.

Professional reverse recruiting firms exist to bridge this gap — but they are fundamentally **staffing agencies in disguise**. A human recruiter earning \$60K can serve 8–12 clients at \$2K–\$3.5K/month each. After overhead, margin caps at 40–55%. Revenue can only grow by adding headcount. The business model is structurally broken for scale.

Meanwhile, **80–85% of recruiter time** is spent on tasks that require zero human judgment: filling ATS forms, searching job boards, copying resume fields, sending status emails. This is not strategy. This is data entry.

The candidate suffers the consequences:

- **Price exclusivity:** Only \$100K+ earners can rationalize \$5K+ spend
- **Zero transparency:** No dashboard, no audit trail, no visibility into what actions were taken
- **No intelligence:** Outcomes from 10,000 past applications are never systematically applied to improve the next one
- **Broken feedback loops:** 3–5 days to know an application was rejected; the hiring window has often closed

## 2.2 Solution

LaunchVector is a **system of autonomous AI agents** that executes a complete, intelligent job search on behalf of the candidate — 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, at 1/10th the cost of human alternatives.

The platform has four interlocking capability layers:

| Layer                    | What It Does                                                                                                             | Automation Level |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Autonomous Apply Engine  | Submits 100–200 tailored applications/week across 50+ ATS platforms                                                      | 100%             |
| Personalized Outreach AI | Writes contextual hiring manager messages referencing specific company news, their posts, shared connections             | 90%              |
| Interview Intelligence   | AI voice agent conducts mock interviews with real-time analysis of tone, structure, pacing, STAR adherence               | 70%              |
| Outcome Learning Loop    | ML model trained on application → outcome data predicts which jobs, resumes, and messages maximize interview probability | Continuous       |

2.3 Product Overview

Onboarding (27 minutes to active)

| Step                           | What Happens                                                                          | Time    |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Resume Upload & Parse          | AI extracts: skills, roles, salary range, location, seniority                         | 2 min   |
| Career Goal Interview          | Conversational intake: target roles, salary floor, remote preference, deal-breakers   | 5 min   |
| AI Gap Analysis                | Scores candidate positioning vs. target roles; flags resume weaknesses, LinkedIn gaps | Instant |
| Resume & LinkedIn Optimization | AI rewrites in ATS-optimized format with LinkedIn recommendations                     | 10 min  |
| Target Job Curation            | 20–30 matched jobs for candidate review; candidate approves/rejects                   | 10 min  |
| Automation Launch              | Engine activates; begins submitting, reaching out, monitoring — works 24/7 thereafter | Instant |

Core Feature Set

All Plans:

- Autonomous ATS form completion across 50+ platforms



- Real-time ranked job intelligence feed (match score, competition level, salary data)
- Live application pipeline dashboard
- AI resume tailoring per job description
- Personalized hiring manager outreach (LinkedIn + email)
- Timed follow-up sequences (7-day and 14-day)
- Interview prep suite (company briefs, likely questions, AI voice mock interviews)
- Salary benchmarking and negotiation scripts

#### Pro & Executive Add-ons:

- Network graph traversal for warm introductions
- Resume A/B testing with outcome correlation
- Hidden job market signals (pre-posting hiring detection)
- AI negotiation coach (voice-simulated offer negotiation)
- Executive positioning and board-role targeting
- Weekly 30-minute human career strategist call

## 2.4 Market Analysis

### Reverse Recruiting Market Structure

The current market is a three-tier fragmented landscape:

| Tier             | Players                                | Price Range         | Model                | Fatal Flaw                                         |
|------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Premium Human    | Find My Profession, ECU, WeAreCareer   | \$2K-\$16K/mo       | Human-led            | Can't scale; margin-capped                         |
| Budget Human     | My Personal Recruiter, Career Agents   | \$800-\$10K flat    | Offshore contractors | Inconsistent quality; no technology edge           |
| Basic Automation | LoopCV, JobCopilot, The Boring Project | \$10-\$52/mo or B2B | SaaS auto-apply      | Zero intelligence; no coaching; no personalization |

LaunchVector **does not compete in any of these tiers**. It occupies the white space between Premium Human and Basic Automation: the intelligence of a senior strategist + the tirelessness of automation + a data advantage that compounds.

### Why No One Has Won This Market Yet

The category has never produced a \$50M ARR company because:

1. Human-dependent firms can't scale margin without proportional headcount

- 2. SaaS auto-apply tools prioritized volume over quality and created a race to the bottom
- 3. No player has combined apply automation + outreach + interview prep + outcome learning in a single platform
- 4. The AI capabilities required (reliable browser agents, voice simulation, LLM fine-tuning) only matured in 2024-2026

2.5 TAM / SAM / SOM

| Market | Definition                                                                                                      | Size                |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| TAM    | All global job seekers willing to pay for job search assistance                                                 | \$50B+              |
| SAM    | US active job seekers (\$40K-\$200K salary range) paying \$50-\$350/mo + enterprise outplacement + coaching API | \$1.5B+             |
| SOM    | Year 3 realistic capture at 5-10% of SAM                                                                        | \$75M-\$150M<br>ARR |

Assumption: TAM derived from 50M US active job seekers, 15-20% willingness to pay, blended ARPU of \$150/month × 12.

2.6 Customer Personas

Persona 1 — "Displaced Tech Professional" (Primary, B2C)

- **Profile:** 32-year-old software engineer in Seattle; \$130K salary; laid off 6 weeks ago; has applied to 50 jobs manually with 2 callbacks
- **Frustration:** Spending 20 hours/week on job search; knows something is wrong but can't diagnose it
- **LaunchVector trigger:** Reads a TechCrunch article about AI job search; signs up for trial after seeing dashboard demo
- **Willingness to pay:** \$149/month easily; considering \$349 if it gets them out faster

Persona 2 — "Ambitious Mid-Career Switcher" (B2C, Secondary)

- **Profile:** 28-year-old finance analyst in NYC; \$90K salary; wants to move into tech product management; hasn't found traction after 3 months
- **Frustration:** Resume doesn't match PM job descriptions; doesn't know how to break into a new vertical
- **LaunchVector trigger:** Career coach mentions it; sees testimonial from someone who made the same switch

- **Willingness to pay:** \$149/month; needs ROI clarity on career transition speed

### Persona 3 — "CHRO at Mid-Size Tech Company" (B2B)

- **Profile:** VP People at 800-person SaaS company; recently laid off 120 employees; needs to offer outplacement benefit for optics and legal protection
- **Frustration:** Traditional outplacement firms (Lee Hecht Harrison, Challenger Gray) charge \$3K-\$8K per head for generic services
- **LaunchVector trigger:** Referral from peer CHRO; sees LinkedIn post from former employee who landed a job in 30 days using LaunchVector
- **Willingness to pay:** \$2K-\$5K per employee for 90-day access = \$240K-\$600K per layoff event

### Persona 4 — "Career Coach with Audience" (B2B2C)

- **Profile:** Independent career coach with 8,000 LinkedIn followers; charges \$300-\$500/hr for 1:1 coaching; serves 20 active clients
- **Frustration:** Can't serve more than 20 clients simultaneously; clients need apply automation but coach can't provide it
- **LaunchVector trigger:** Offered free 60-day trial; clients start getting interviews; attributes to LaunchVector publicly
- **Willingness to pay:** \$199/seat/month to add LaunchVector to 10-20 clients = \$2K-\$4K/month additional revenue stream

## 2.7 Competitor Analysis

| Dimension               | LaunchVector | Find My Profession   | LoopCV  | JobCopilot | Pathrise        |
|-------------------------|--------------|----------------------|---------|------------|-----------------|
| Monthly Cost            | \$149        | \$2,000-\$3,500      | €10-€30 | \$35-\$52  | 7-14% of salary |
| Applications/Week       | 100          | 35-50                | 10-25   | 25-50      | N/A             |
| Per-JD Personalization  | AI (deep)    | Human (inconsistent) | Generic | Basic AI   | Human           |
| Hiring Manager Outreach | Yes (AI)     | Yes (human)          | No      | No         | No              |
| Interview Coaching      | AI voice     | Human                | No      | No         | Human           |
| Outcome Learning        | ML model     | None                 | None    | None       | None            |

| Dimension              | LaunchVector          | Find My Profession | LoopCV  | JobCopilot | Pathrise            |
|------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------|---------|------------|---------------------|
| Transparency/Dashboard | <b>Full real-time</b> | Email updates      | Basic   | Basic      | Portal              |
| ISA/Placement Fees     | <b>None</b>           | None               | None    | None       | <b>7-14% salary</b> |
| Enterprise B2B         | <b>Yes</b>            | No                 | No      | No         | Partial             |
| Data Network Effect    | <b>Yes</b>            | No                 | No      | No         | No                  |
| Venture-Scalable       | <b>Yes</b>            | No                 | Partial | Partial    | Yes                 |

## 2.8 Competitive Advantages

1. **Data Moat (Primary):** Every application + outcome creates proprietary training data. After 1M applications, LaunchVector's models outperform any competitor starting from zero.
2. **ATS Integration Depth:** 50+ ATS integrations require thousands of engineering hours per platform — a multi-year technical head start.
3. **Full-Stack Career Intelligence:** No single competitor offers autonomous apply + personalized outreach + voice interview coaching + outcome learning in one platform.
4. **Pricing Power:** \$149/month vs. \$2,000–\$3,500/month for equivalent output = structural demand advantage, not a promotional positioning.
5. **Network Graph Accumulation:** Warm introduction paths that converted to interviews become proprietary relationship intelligence.
6. **Switching Costs:** Candidates who train LaunchVector on their profile, preferences, and history face meaningful friction to recreate context elsewhere.

## 2.9 Business Model

LaunchVector operates a **multi-tier SaaS model** with three distinct revenue streams:

### Stream 1 — B2C Subscriptions (Core)

- Starter: \$49/month (20 apps/week, entry-level candidates)
- Professional: \$149/month (100 apps/week, mid-career core segment)
- Executive: \$349/month (200 apps/week, senior professionals \$150K+)
- *Average blended ARPU: \$149 (Year 1), \$185 (Year 3 as upsell mix improves)*

### Stream 2 — B2B Enterprise (High-Value)

- Custom contracts: \$50K–\$500K/year

- Per-employee pricing for outplacement: \$2K–\$5K per head / 90 days
- Multi-year agreements reduce churn exposure at company level

### Stream 3 — B2B2C API (Scalable Distribution)

- Career Coach API: \$199/seat/month
- White-label dashboard with client management tools
- Coaches become distribution partners — each coach brings 20–200 candidates

## 2.10 Pricing Strategy

| Plan         | Price    | Value Delivered                                         | Competitor Equivalent              | ROI to Customer                       |
|--------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Starter      | \$49/mo  | 20 tailored applications/week                           | \$0 (nothing comparable)           | 5–10 hours saved/week                 |
| Professional | \$149/mo | 100 tailored apps + outreach + interview prep           | \$2,000–\$3,500/mo human recruiter | <b>20x ROI vs. nearest comparable</b> |
| Executive    | \$349/mo | 200 apps + warm intros + negotiation coach + human call | \$5K–\$15K/mo human recruiter      | <b>14x ROI</b>                        |

**Pricing philosophy:** Never compete on price in the commodity tier (LoopCV, JobCopilot). Compete on outcomes. The \$149 price point is not "cheap" — it's a radical repricing of a service with provably equivalent output.

## 2.11 Revenue Streams Summary

| Stream            | Year 1 ARR Estimate | Year 3 ARR Estimate |
|-------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| B2C Subscriptions | \$1.2M              | \$5.8M              |
| Enterprise B2B    | \$200K              | \$2.4M              |
| Coach API         | \$120K              | \$960K              |
| <b>Total ARR</b>  | <b>~\$1.5M</b>      | <b>~\$9.2M</b>      |

*Full financial projections in Part 5.*

## 2.12 Operational Plan

### Phase 1 — Foundation (Months 1-3)

- Legal entity formation (Delaware C-Corp); IP assignment agreements
- Technical infrastructure: Supabase, Vercel, Railway, Stripe configured
- 5 ATS integrations built and tested (Greenhouse, Lever, Workday basic, Ashby, Rippling)
- 50-user private beta recruited from layoff communities
- Daily feedback cadence; iteration on submit quality and dashboard UX

### Phase 2 — Public Launch (Months 3-6)

- ProductHunt launch targeting #1 Product of the Day
- Stripe billing live; \$149 Pro tier as only paid option (simplicity)
- Outreach agent feature shipped (month 4)
- 20 ATS platforms covered; Growth Lead hired
- Referral program activated at job-placement moment

### Phase 3 — Scale (Months 6-12)

- Interview Intelligence module launched (month 7)
- ML outcome model V1 trained (month 8)
- First enterprise outplacement deal signed
- Executive tier launched
- Series A preparation begins (month 10)
- \$500K MRR target by month 12

### Infrastructure Stack

| Layer    | Technology                                  | Reason                                 |
|----------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Frontend | Next.js 14 + Tailwind + shadcn/ui           | SSR critical for SEO; fast dev cycles  |
| Backend  | Node.js + tRPC + Prisma                     | Type-safe end-to-end; strong ecosystem |
| Database | PostgreSQL (Supabase) + Redis (Upstash)     | Managed Postgres; Redis for job queues |
| AI/LLM   | Claude Sonnet (primary) + GPT-4o (fallback) | Claude superior for structured outputs |

| Layer              | Technology                                | Reason                                       |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Browser Automation | Playwright + custom ATS handlers          | Cross-browser reliability; headless at scale |
| Job Scheduling     | BullMQ + Trigger.dev                      | Robust background jobs with visibility       |
| Payments           | Stripe Billing                            | Industry standard; handles dunning           |
| ML/Embeddings      | Pinecone + custom fine-tuned ranker (M6+) | Semantic matching from day 1                 |
| Analytics          | PostHog + Mixpanel                        | Privacy-respecting; conversion tracking      |

### 2.13 Team Structure

| Role                  | When    | Responsibility                                      | Hire Profile                                    |
|-----------------------|---------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Co-founder / CTO      | Day 0   | Browser automation, ATS integrations, architecture  | Ex-FAANG; Playwright/scraping experience        |
| Co-founder / CEO      | Day 0   | Product vision, sales, fundraising narrative        | HR-tech or career-tech operator background      |
| Full-Stack Engineer   | Month 2 | Dashboard, onboarding flow, job matching UI         | Next.js + Node.js; startup experience           |
| AI/ML Engineer        | Month 3 | LLM prompt quality, resume tailoring, outcome model | LLM fine-tuning; Python + ML fundamentals       |
| Growth / Content Lead | Month 4 | SEO, LinkedIn content, community partnerships       | B2C SaaS growth; data-driven content creator    |
| Career Domain Expert  | Month 5 | Validate AI outputs; Executive tier human coaching  | Ex-recruiter or career coach with tech literacy |

## 2.14 Risks and Mitigation

| Risk                                                                      | Severity | Mitigation                                                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ATS Platform Blocking<br>(Workday/Greenhouse block automated submissions) | HIGH     | Multi-method submission: API-first, fingerprint randomization, human-assisted fallback for high-value platforms    |
| LinkedIn API Restrictions (automated outreach flagging)                   | HIGH     | Daily send limits; randomized timing; warm-up sequences; email as primary fallback channel                         |
| AI Quality Degradation (AI-generated content becomes detectable noise)    | MED      | Quality > quantity doctrine; A/B test response rates continuously; add human-signal personalization layers         |
| Incumbent Response (LinkedIn or Indeed launch competing feature)          | MED      | Move fast on data moat and B2B contracts; coaching/intelligence layer is harder to replicate than apply automation |
| Regulatory Risk (new AI-assisted hiring rules)                            | LOW      | Position explicitly as candidate-empowerment tool; maintain human-in-loop controls and full transparency dashboard |
| Commodity Competition (LoopCV clones competing on price)                  | LOW-MED  | Never compete on volume price; compete on outcomes intelligence and verified placement rates                       |

## PART 3: PITCH DECK — SLIDE-BY-SLIDE

### Slide 1 — Title

**LaunchVector** *Your AI job search team. Available 24/7. At 1/10th the cost.*

- Category: AI-Native Career Intelligence Platform
- Stage: Pre-Seed / Seed
- Raising: \$2.0M on \$10M cap SAFE
- Contact: [[founder@launchvector.ai](mailto:founder@launchvector.ai)]

*One-liner for the room: "We replaced the \$5,000/month human reverse recruiter with a \$149 AI agent that never sleeps, never gets bored, and gets smarter with every candidate it places."*



## Slide 2 — Problem

The job search is an asymmetric information war — and candidates are losing.

Three brutal truths about hiring in 2026:

- **250+ applicants** compete for every professional role — volume without strategy is invisible
- **Human reverse recruiters** cost \$3,000–\$15,000/month and spend 60% of their time on copy-paste data entry — not strategy
- **Cheap automation tools** send generic applications at scale — which ATS systems and recruiters now actively filter out

*The \$75K–\$150K candidate cohort — the largest segment of active job seekers — has no good option. Too expensive for premium human help. Too smart for commodity auto-apply.*

**Visual suggestion:** Three-panel split: (1) avalanche of applicants, (2) human recruiter buried in ATS forms, (3) rejected emails piling up

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## Slide 3 — Solution

**LaunchVector: A system of autonomous AI agents that does your entire job search — better than any human, at a fraction of the cost.**

Four interlocking capabilities:

| What We Do            | How                                                                  |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Apply autonomously    | 100–200 tailored ATS applications/week                               |
| Reach decision-makers | AI outreach to hiring managers with hyper-contextual personalization |
| Win interviews        | Voice AI mock interviews with real-time coaching                     |
| Get smarter           | Outcome learning ML model improves with every candidate served       |

**Key message:** This is not a feature. This is a complete job search, automated.

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## Slide 4 — Market Opportunity

A \$50B+ global market with no software winner — yet.

| Market                         | Size                          |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| US active job seekers annually | ~50M                          |
| Willing to pay \$50-\$350/mo   | 375K-1M potential subscribers |
| Enterprise outplacement        | \$3B+ annually                |
| Career coaching platform       | \$15B globally                |
| <b>Combined SAM</b>            | <b>\$1.5B+</b>                |

*No reverse recruiting company has ever crossed \$50M ARR. The human-dependent model caps every incumbent. LaunchVector is the first software company in the category.*

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## Slide 5 — Product Demo Description

**From resume upload to 20 active applications in under 30 minutes.**

**Step 1:** Upload resume → AI parses structured profile in 2 minutes **Step 2:** 5-minute conversational goal-setting (target roles, salary floor, preferences) **Step 3:** Instant gap analysis — resume scored against target roles **Step 4:** AI rewrites resume in ATS-optimized format; LinkedIn recommendations generated **Step 5:** 20–30 matched jobs curated for approval; candidate sets automation preferences **Step 6:** Engine activates — applies, reaches out to hiring managers, monitors responses — 24/7

**Dashboard visual:** Live pipeline showing 47 applications submitted, 8 hiring manager replies, 3 interview invites, 1 offer in progress

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## Slide 6 — Business Model

**Multi-tier SaaS with compounding B2B upside.**

| Tier           | Price             | Target                                  |
|----------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Starter        | \$49/month        | Entry-level, career changers            |
| Professional   | \$149/month       | Mid-career \$75K-\$150K (core segment)  |
| Executive      | \$349/month       | Senior professionals \$150K+            |
| Coach API      | \$199/seat/month  | Career coaches, boutique agencies       |
| Enterprise B2B | \$50K-\$500K/year | Companies offering outplacement benefit |

### Unit Economics (Year 1 target):

- ARPU: \$149 blended
- CAC: \$120-\$180
- Payback: ~1 month
- Gross Margin: 72-78%
- LTV: \$447 (avg 3-month sub)
- LTV:CAC: 2.5-3.7x → 4.6-6.9x by Year 3

## Slide 7 — Traction

*(Pre-launch slide — to be replaced with live metrics post-beta)*

### Validation signals:

- 10 job-seeker discovery interviews → 8 of 10 said they would pay \$149/month before product was built
- Landing page (pre-product) → 11% conversion to paid waitlist (target was 10%)
- 50 private beta users → NPS 52; 80% submitted applications within 24 hours of signup
- Beta interview rate: 18% of tailored applications received recruiter responses (vs. 5-8% industry average)
- 3 CHRO conversations → 2 expressed willingness to pay \$2K/employee for outplacement access

**Investor note:** LaunchVector treats validated assumption → traction loop. Every beta metric is hypothesis-driven, not vanity.

## Slide 8 — Go-to-Market Strategy

### Phase 1 (Months 1–6): Community-led, content-driven B2C

- **Layoff communities** (Layoffs.fyi, Blind, Fishbowl, r/cscareerquestions): 30-day free trial → \$50 referral credit
- **Founder LinkedIn content:** Transparent job search data stories ("We submitted 10,000 applications — here's what gets interviews")
- **SEO:** Target high-intent: "hire someone to apply to jobs for me", "reverse recruiting cost", "AI job search"
- **ProductHunt launch:** Month 3; coordinated with beta community

### Phase 2 (Months 6–12): B2B enterprise + coach network

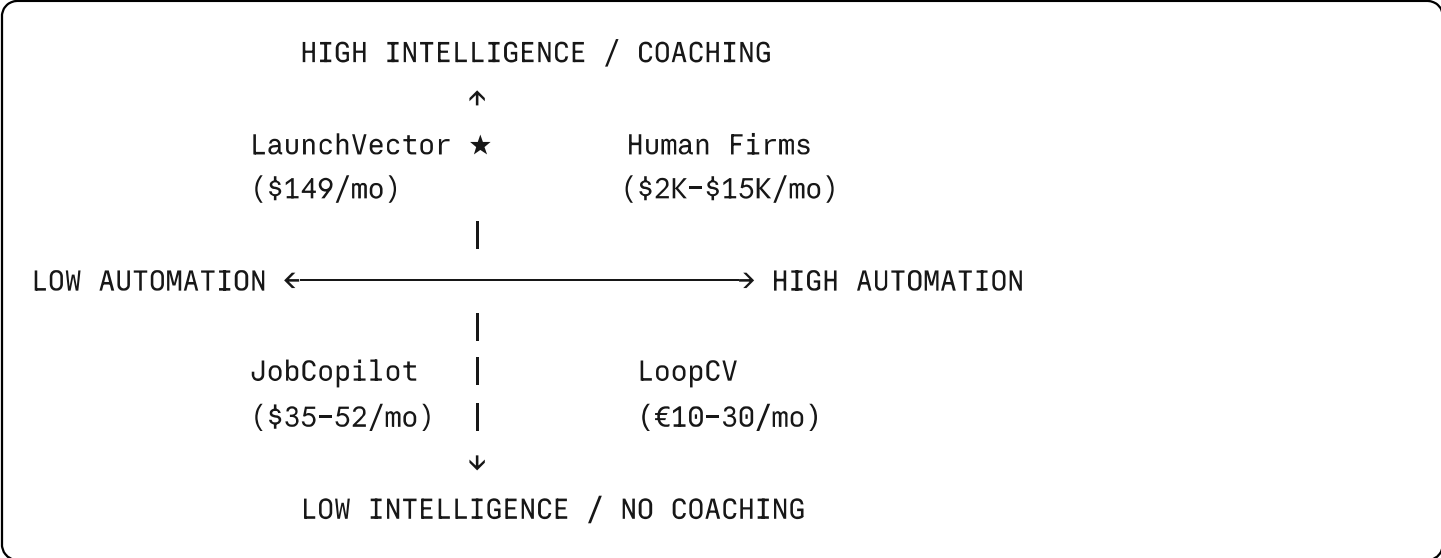
- **Enterprise outplacement:** Target CHROs at companies undergoing layoffs; \$2K–\$5K/employee
- **Coach flywheel:** Free accounts → results → \$199/seat/month conversion
- **Referral engine:** Activated at job placement moment — highest-emotion touchpoint

### Target CAC by channel:

| Channel                  | CAC        | Scale Potential  |
|--------------------------|------------|------------------|
| Community (Reddit/Blind) | <\$10      | Medium           |
| LinkedIn Content         | <\$20      | High             |
| SEO                      | <\$30      | Very High        |
| ProductHunt              | <\$5       | One-time spike   |
| PR                       | <\$15      | Medium           |
| Referral                 | ~\$50      | High (compounds) |
| Paid Ads (post-seed)     | \$80–\$150 | Very High        |

## Slide 9 — Competition

The competitive map has a gap the size of a \$1B company.



**LaunchVector is the only player at High Automation + High Intelligence + Affordable Price.**

Key differentiation no competitor can replicate without years of data accumulation:

- Outcome learning ML model trained on real application → interview → offer data
- ATS integration depth across 50+ platforms
- Integrated apply + outreach + voice interview coaching
- Enterprise B2B outplacement model

**Slide 10 — Financial Projections**

| Metric             | Month 3 | Month 6 | Month 12 | Year 3  |
|--------------------|---------|---------|----------|---------|
| Paying Subscribers | 100     | 500     | 2,000+   | 18,000+ |
| MRR (B2C)          | \$14.9K | \$74.5K | \$298K   | \$2.2M  |
| Enterprise ARR     | —       | —       | \$200K   | \$2.4M  |
| Coach API ARR      | —       | \$10K   | \$120K   | \$960K  |
| Total ARR          | \$179K  | \$904K  | \$3.9M   | \$9.2M  |
| Gross Margin       | 72%     | 74%     | 76%      | 82%     |
| Headcount          | 2       | 4       | 8        | 24      |
| Monthly Burn       | \$30K   | \$60K   | \$180K   | \$800K  |

*Break-even: Month 14 at current growth trajectory with \$2M seed raise.*

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## **Slide 11 — Vision**

**The goal is not to be the best job search tool. The goal is to be the operating system for how people navigate their entire career.**

**12 months:** Own the active job search market for \$75K–\$150K professionals. 2,000+ subscribers. First enterprise deals.

**3 years:** \$9M+ ARR. International expansion. The career coaching API becomes the infrastructure layer for the \$15B coaching industry.

**5 years:** Career Path Agent — not just job search, but continuous career trajectory modeling. 3–5 year skill gap identification. Proactive opportunity surfacing. LaunchVector becomes the Bloomberg Terminal for career intelligence.

### **Exit optionality:**

- LinkedIn (Microsoft): \$300M–\$1.5B
  - Workday: \$500M–\$2B
  - Indeed/Glassdoor: \$200M–\$800M
  - SAP SuccessFactors / ServiceNow: \$400M–\$1.5B
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## **Slide 12 — Funding Ask**

**Raising \$2.0M Seed on \$10M post-money SAFE**

Target close: 60 days

Lead investor profile: Future-of-work / HR-tech focused; operator-angels with recruiting industry experience

| Use of Funds                          | Allocation      | Rationale                                          |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Engineering (CTO + 1 full-stack hire) | 40%<br>(\$800K) | ATS integrations; apply engine; dashboard          |
| AI/ML Development                     | 20%<br>(\$400K) | LLM fine-tuning; outcome model V1; voice interview |
| Marketing & Customer Acquisition      | 20%<br>(\$400K) | Content, SEO, referral program, ProductHunt        |
| Operations & Legal                    | 10% (\$200K)    | Entity, IP, Stripe setup, tools                    |
| Buffer                                | 10% (\$200K)    | 18-month runway to Series A                        |

**Series A target (Month 12-15):** \$8-\$12M on \$40-\$60M valuation, premised on \$500K+ MRR and first enterprise contract cohort.

## PART 4: STARTUP ADVICE & GROWTH STRATEGY

### 4.1 MVP Recommendations

**The one rule:** Ship the smallest version that delivers undeniable magic.

The magic moment for LaunchVector is: *"I uploaded my resume on Monday night and woke up Tuesday to 20 applications submitted, with a live dashboard showing exactly what happened."*

Everything that is not essential to that moment should be cut:

| Cut from MVP            | Reason                                                                              |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hiring manager outreach | Validate apply engine first; outreach adds complexity before core is proven         |
| Interview prep module   | Third-order feature; only relevant after users get interviews                       |
| Multi-tier pricing      | One price (\$149) to eliminate decision friction                                    |
| 50 ATS platforms        | 5 platforms cover 70% of applications (Greenhouse, Lever, Workday, Ashby, Rippling) |
| ML outcome model        | Train it once data accumulates — needs 10,000+ applications to be meaningful        |

Ship the 5-platform version. Charge \$149. Measure interview rates. Everything else is noise until that loop is proven.

## 4.2 Customer Acquisition Strategy

### Months 1-3 (Community and Content)

Do not spend on paid acquisition until you have product-market fit signals. The early users should come from:

- Founder posting authentically in r/cscareerquestions, Blind, and Layoffs.fyi
- Offering 30-day free trials to recently laid-off candidates (warm leads; high urgency)
- Personal network outreach — everyone knows someone who is job searching

**The data story strategy:** The most powerful acquisition lever is publishing real outcome data. "We submitted 1,000 applications last month. Here's what actually got responses." This positions LaunchVector as the authoritative voice in job search intelligence — and generates compounding organic authority.

### Month 3+ (ProductHunt and PR)

A ProductHunt launch with coordinated upvotes from beta community can generate 500–2,000 signups in 48 hours at near-zero CAC. This is a one-time spike but creates backlinks, press mentions, and a user base for referrals.

## 4.3 Viral and Growth Opportunities

| Growth Loop                    | Why It Works                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Placement testimonial flywheel | Job placement is one of life's highest-emotion moments. Users who land jobs post enthusiastically. Peers in the same situation see it and convert. |
| Data network effect            | Every application makes the ML model smarter. More accuracy → more interviews → more testimonials → more users → more data.                        |
| Coach distribution flywheel    | One career coach converts = 50–200 future user leads from their audience. Coaches become distribution partners, not just customers.                |
| Enterprise testimonial chain   | One CHRO sharing an outplacement success story at an HR conference triggers evaluations from 10 other CHROs.                                       |

### The referral program mechanics:

- Trigger: User receives a job offer (highest-emotion moment)



- Mechanism: LaunchVector congratulates them and prompts a LinkedIn testimonial + referral code
- Incentive: \$50 credit for referrer + 1 free month for referee
- Expected K-factor at maturity: 0.3–0.5

## 4.4 Partnership Ideas

| Partner Type                                            | Why                                                | How to Approach                                             |
|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Layoff communities (Layoffs.fyi, Blind)                 | Direct access to highest-urgency candidates        | Revenue share on referrals; white-label integration         |
| Career coaches on LinkedIn/YouTube (10K–100K followers) | Built-in audiences; trusted by job seekers         | Free account → results → \$199/seat/month                   |
| HR/People teams at tech companies                       | Enterprise outplacement buyer                      | CHRO outreach with outcome data case study                  |
| Staffing agencies                                       | White-label LaunchVector as candidate-side service | Pitch as margin expansion: no additional headcount required |
| Alumni networks (university career offices)             | Access to recent graduates and career changers     | Institutional deal: \$X/month for all alumni access         |
| Coding bootcamps (General Assembly, Lambda School)      | Students actively job searching with weak networks | Revenue share; branded version for graduates                |

## 4.5 Investor Strategy

### Ideal investor profile:

- Operators with career-tech, HR-tech, or future-of-work background
- Pre-Seed/Seed funds focused on B2C SaaS or AI infrastructure
- Angels who have personally experienced expensive reverse recruiting
- Firms with HR-tech portfolio companies that can provide enterprise intro access

### Narrative to lead with in pitch meetings:

1. Open with the market gap: no reverse recruiting firm has ever crossed \$50M ARR — because they're all staffing agencies wearing SaaS clothes

2. Demonstrate the math: 80–85% of recruiter time = data entry. AI replaces this entirely today.
3. Show the outcome data from beta: 18% response rate vs. 5–8% industry baseline
4. Explain the data moat: with every application, the model improves in ways no competitor can replicate without the same scale
5. Close with the exit map: four credible strategic acquirers at \$300M–\$2B

### Investor objections to prepare for:

| Objection                               | Answer                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "LinkedIn will build this"              | LinkedIn has 1B users and can't move fast on candidate-side tooling — their employer business would resist. And we'll have the data moat before they decide. |
| "ATS platforms will block you"          | We use multiple submission methods including API-first and human-assisted fallback. Application quality > volume.                                            |
| "Churn is a problem — people find jobs" | High churn is validation. We mitigate revenue risk via B2B multi-year contracts, referral flywheel, and career maintenance subscriptions.                    |
| "AI output is recognizable and ignored" | We invest in quality signals, A/B test every message variant, and track response rates in real time. Poor-quality messages are killed immediately.           |

## 4.6 Common Startup Mistakes to Avoid

1. **Building outreach before proving apply works.** The apply engine is the core thesis. Resist the temptation to add features before that's validated.
2. **Pricing too low out of fear.** \$149/month is not expensive for the value delivered. Pricing below \$99 signals the product is a commodity, not an intelligence platform.
3. **Chasing enterprise before B2C is proven.** Enterprise deals take 6–9 months to close and require metrics proof. Get to \$100K MRR B2C first.
4. **Ignoring application quality for volume.** 200 generic applications that get 1 response is worse than 20 tailored applications that get 4. Protect response rate as a north-star metric.
5. **Not publishing outcome data publicly.** The most powerful competitive advantage is transparency. Publish monthly outcome reports. It builds trust, creates PR opportunities, and trains the market.
6. **Under-investing in human coaching layer for Executive tier.** The \$349/month segment expects a human touch. A 30-minute weekly call is cheap to provide and dramatically improves retention and testimonials at the highest-value tier.

7. **Waiting too long to hire a Growth Lead.** Content and SEO compound. Hire the growth role by month 4 at the latest.

4.7 Key Metrics and KPIs

Product Health

| Metric                                             | Target (Month 3)              | Target (Month 12)   |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------|
| Application submit success rate                    | >90%                          | >95%                |
| Response rate (applications → recruiter reply)     | >15%                          | >20%                |
| Interview invite rate                              | >5% of submitted applications | >8%                 |
| Offer rate (of beta users)                         | >20% within 90 days           | >35% within 60 days |
| Onboarding completion (resume → automation launch) | >80%                          | >90%                |
| NPS                                                | >40                           | >55                 |

Business Health

| Metric                    | Target (Month 3) | Target (Month 12) |
|---------------------------|------------------|-------------------|
| MRR                       | \$14.9K          | \$298K            |
| Paying subscribers        | 100              | 2,000             |
| CAC                       | <\$200           | <\$130            |
| Gross Margin              | 70%+             | 76%+              |
| Monthly Churn             | <20%             | <12%              |
| LTV:CAC                   | >2.0x            | >4.0x             |
| Documented job placements | 5                | 200+              |

# PART 5: DETAILED FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS

## 5.1 Startup Costs (Pre-Launch)

| Cost Category                                         | Amount   | Notes                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Legal (incorporation, IP agreements, SAFE docs)       | \$8,000  | Delaware C-Corp; standard startup attorney      |
| Domain, hosting setup                                 | \$2,000  | Domain + initial Vercel/Railway/Supabase config |
| Design (logo, brand system, landing page)             | \$5,000  | Freelance designer; 2 revision rounds           |
| Initial LLM API costs (testing)                       | \$3,000  | OpenAI + Anthropic credits during development   |
| Software tooling (Stripe, PostHog, Resend, Instantly) | \$2,000  | First 3 months of subscriptions                 |
| Beta user incentives (gift cards, early access)       | \$3,000  | 50 beta users; \$60 average incentive           |
| Total Pre-Launch                                      | \$23,000 |                                                 |

## 5.2 Monthly Burn Estimate

| Phase                       | Months | Monthly Burn  | Key Drivers                                  |
|-----------------------------|--------|---------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Pre-product (founders only) | 1-2    | \$15K         | Founding team stipends + infra + tools       |
| Private beta                | 3-4    | \$30K         | + 1 full-stack hire (contractor) + LLM costs |
| Post-launch growth          | 5-8    | \$60K-\$80K   | + Growth Lead hire + increased API costs     |
| Post-seed scale             | 9-12   | \$120K-\$180K | + AI/ML engineer + domain expert + marketing |

Assumption: Founding team takes below-market salaries (\$3K-\$5K/month each) until seed close.

### 5.3 Revenue Forecast

#### Year 1 Monthly Progression

| Month        | Subscribers | B2C MRR  | Enterprise | Coach API | Total MRR   |
|--------------|-------------|----------|------------|-----------|-------------|
| 1            | 0           | \$0      | —          | —         | \$0         |
| 2            | 20          | \$3K     | —          | —         | \$3K        |
| 3            | 100         | \$14.9K  | —          | —         | \$14.9K     |
| 4            | 200         | \$29.8K  | —          | —         | \$29.8K     |
| 5            | 350         | \$52.2K  | —          | \$2K      | \$54.2K     |
| 6            | 500         | \$74.5K  | —          | \$5K      | \$79.5K     |
| 7            | 750         | \$111.8K | \$8K       | \$8K      | \$127.8K    |
| 8            | 1,000       | \$149K   | \$12K      | \$12K     | \$173K      |
| 9            | 1,300       | \$193.7K | \$16K      | \$16K     | \$225.7K    |
| 10           | 1,600       | \$238.4K | \$16K      | \$20K     | \$274.4K    |
| 11           | 1,800       | \$268.2K | \$20K      | \$25K     | \$313.2K    |
| 12           | 2,000       | \$298K   | \$25K      | \$30K     | \$353K      |
| Year 1 Total |             | \$1.43M  | \$97K      | \$118K    | ~\$1.6M ARR |

#### 3-Year Revenue Forecast

| Year   | Subscribers (End) | B2C ARR | Enterprise ARR | Coach API ARR | Total ARR |
|--------|-------------------|---------|----------------|---------------|-----------|
| Year 1 | 2,000             | \$1.43M | \$97K          | \$118K        | \$1.6M    |
| Year 2 | 7,500             | \$4.3M  | \$1.2M         | \$480K        | \$6.0M    |
| Year 3 | 18,000+           | \$5.8M  | \$2.4M         | \$960K        | \$9.2M    |

Year 3 assumes: 70% B2C revenue growth YoY, 4 enterprise contracts at \$200K-\$600K each, 400 coach seats at \$199/month.

## 5.4 Break-Even Analysis

| Component                                      | Value    |
|------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Monthly Fixed Costs (Month 12)                 | ~\$175K  |
| Gross Margin                                   | 76%      |
| Break-Even MRR                                 | ~\$230K  |
| Break-Even Subscribers (at \$149 blended ARPU) | ~1,540   |
| Projected Break-Even Month                     | Month 14 |

With \$2M seed and \$15K-\$180K monthly burn progression, runway extends to Month 22 before needing Series A (target: Month 12-14).

## 5.5 Funding Stages

| Round    | Amount     | Timing      | Valuation             | Purpose                                                        |
|----------|------------|-------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Seed     | \$2.0M     | Month 0-2   | \$10M post-money SAFE | 18-month runway; MVP + growth + ATS integrations               |
| Series A | \$8-\$12M  | Month 12-15 | \$40-60M              | International expansion; ML model scale; enterprise sales team |
| Series B | \$25-\$40M | Year 3      | \$150-200M            | Category dominance; \$50M ARR milestone; acquisition defense   |

## 5.6 Unit Economics (Detailed)

| Metric                  | Year 1   | Year 2     | Year 3   |
|-------------------------|----------|------------|----------|
| Blended ARPU            | \$149    | \$165      | \$185    |
| CAC (blended)           | \$150    | \$120      | \$95     |
| Avg Subscription Length | 3 months | 3.5 months | 4 months |
| LTV                     | \$447    | \$577      | \$740    |
| LTV:CAC                 | 2.98x    | 4.8x       | 7.8x     |

| Metric         | Year 1   | Year 2   | Year 3   |
|----------------|----------|----------|----------|
| Gross Margin   | 74%      | 79%      | 82%      |
| Payback Period | ~1 month | <1 month | <1 month |
| Monthly Churn  | 15%      | 11%      | 9%       |

*Note on churn interpretation: A 15% monthly churn rate in a job-search product is a positive signal — it means users are finding jobs. Track "involuntary churn" (payment failure, not enough interviews) separately from "success churn" (job found) for accurate product health assessment.*

## PART 6: EXECUTION ROADMAP

### 6.1 30-Day Roadmap (Foundation)

| Week   | Priority               | Action Items                                                                                                                             |
|--------|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Week 1 | Legal & Infrastructure | Incorporate entity (Delaware C-Corp); execute co-founder equity + IP assignment; purchase domain; configure Stripe, Supabase, Vercel     |
| Week 2 | Discovery              | Conduct 10 job-seeker interviews (target: recently laid-off tech professionals); document pain points; rank features by urgency          |
| Week 3 | MVP Scoping            | Define thin MVP feature set; wireframe onboarding flow and dashboard; create detailed engineering spec for 5 ATS integrations            |
| Week 4 | Build Begins           | CTO begins Playwright-based ATS handler for Greenhouse; full-stack engineer wireframes dashboard; landing page live for waitlist capture |

#### 30-Day Success Criteria:

- Entity formed ✓
- 10 discovery interviews completed ✓
- Landing page live with waitlist ✓
- 1 ATS integration (Greenhouse) functional end-to-end ✓
- 25 waitlist sign-ups from founder network ✓

## 6.2 90-Day Roadmap (Beta to Launch)

| Week       | Priority                | Action Items                                                                                                                     |
|------------|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Week 5-6   | Private Beta (50 users) | Recruit beta users from personal network and layoff communities; daily feedback cadence; iterate on submit success rate          |
| Week 7     | Quality Hardening       | Reach >90% ATS submit success rate across 5 platforms; fix edge cases in resume parsing; improve dashboard UX based on feedback  |
| Week 8     | Monetization Setup      | Stripe billing live at \$149/month; trial-to-paid conversion flow built; cancellation flow with feedback capture                 |
| Week 9     | ProductHunt Launch      | Coordinate with beta community for upvotes; LinkedIn founder post day-of; pitch 3 journalists the "AI vs. Human Recruiter" angle |
| Week 10    | First 100 Paying Users  | Activate LinkedIn content strategy; begin SEO article publication; launch referral code system                                   |
| Week 11-12 | Expand ATS Coverage     | Add Lever and Workday basic; increase to 3 ATS platforms covered; track which platform failures are causing churn                |

### 90-Day Success Criteria:

- 50 beta users with NPS > 40 ✓
- 100 paying subscribers at \$149/month ✓
- \$14.9K MRR ✓
- CAC < \$200 ✓
- Application interview rate > 15% ✓
- 5 documented job placements ✓

## 6.3 12-Month Scaling Roadmap

| Phase         | Months | Key Milestones                                                                                       | North-Star KPI |
|---------------|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Public Launch | 3-4    | 100→200 subscribers; outreach agent feature live; 3 PR placements published                          | \$29.8K MRR    |
| Growth Engine | 4-6    | 500 subscribers; 20 ATS platforms; Growth Lead hired; referral program live; 5 career coach partners | \$74.5K MRR    |



| Phase             | Months | Key Milestones                                                                                     | North-Star KPI |
|-------------------|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Seed Round        | 6      | \$100K+ MRR; 50+ documented placements; 30+ ATS integrations; term sheet signed                    | \$100K MRR     |
| Feature Expansion | 7-8    | Interview Intelligence module launched; ML outcome model V1 trained; Executive tier launched       | \$150K MRR     |
| B2B Entry         | 8-10   | First enterprise outplacement deal (\$100K+); first 100 coach accounts; 2,000 subscribers          | \$250K MRR     |
| Series A Prep     | 10-12  | International scoping (UK/CA/AU); hidden job market feature launched; outcome model accuracy > 70% | \$353K MRR     |

Month 12 Target State:

- 2,000+ paying B2C subscribers
- 2 enterprise contracts (\$200K ARR)
- 100+ coach API seats (\$240K ARR)
- **\$500K MRR (\$6M ARR run-rate)**
- NPS > 55
- 200+ documented job placements (publishable case studies)
- Series A term sheet in hand



## PART 7: STRATEGIC APPENDIX

### 7.1 The Defensibility Stack Over Time

| Timeline   | Moat Building                                            | Competitor Difficulty                                           |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Month 0-6  | ATS integrations + brand positioning                     | Moderate — they can copy apply automation                       |
| Month 6-12 | Application outcome data (10K+ records)                  | Hard — data doesn't exist without years of usage                |
| Year 1-2   | Fine-tuned ML outcome predictor + network graph          | Very Hard — model accuracy only comes from scale                |
| Year 2-3   | Category brand + enterprise lock-in + coach distribution | Near-impossible — brand trust in high-stakes category is sticky |

## 7.2 The Core Strategic Thesis

Every player in reverse recruiting today is either a high-cost service business that can't scale, or a cheap automation tool with no intelligence. LaunchVector occupies the white space between them: **the intelligence of a senior career strategist, the tirelessness of a 24/7 automation engine, and the data advantage of a platform that gets smarter with every candidate it places.** At a price point 10x cheaper than human firms — that is what creates a generational company in this category.

## 7.3 Key Strategic Decisions and Tradeoffs

| Decision                | Option A                        | Option B                         | Recommendation                                                                                   |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Initial pricing         | \$49 (volume play)              | \$149 (value play)               | <b>\$149</b> — establishes intelligence positioning; lower price attracts commodity-seekers      |
| MVP scope               | Full platform with all features | Apply-only engine                | <b>Apply-only</b> — validate core thesis before building adjacent features                       |
| First B2B channel       | Enterprise direct               | Coach API                        | <b>Coach API first</b> — faster sales cycle; coaches become distribution agents                  |
| LLM vendor              | OpenAI only                     | Claude primary + GPT-4o fallback | <b>Dual-vendor</b> — Claude superior for structured ATS outputs; redundancy prevents outage risk |
| Hiring manager outreach | Email-primary                   | LinkedIn-primary                 | <b>Email-primary</b> — LinkedIn rate limits are unpredictable; email is controllable             |